

ArabicNLP 2026

The Fourth Arabic Natural Language Processing Conference

Volume 2. Proceedings of the ArabicNLP 2026 Shared Tasks

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Introduction

Welcome to the proceedings of the Shared Tasks at the **Third Arabic Natural Language Processing Conference (ArabicNLP 2025)**, co-located with **EMNLP 2025** in Suzhou, China, November 8–9, 2025.

This volume represents a major achievement in collaborative Arabic NLP research, bringing together a total of **138 papers from 11 shared tasks** — including **11 overview papers** and **127 system description papers** from participating teams worldwide. This substantial collection reflects the growing vitality and maturity of the Arabic NLP research community and showcases the field’s expansion into increasingly diverse and sophisticated challenges.

This collection highlights the community’s growing interest toward evaluating, aligning, and extending these models for Arabic — across text, speech, and multimodal domains, as well as culturally grounded and ethically sensitive applications. This year marks a record milestone for ArabicNLP, featuring the largest number of shared tasks to date — **11 in total**. The process began with **26 submitted shared task proposals**, from which **11 shared tasks were accepted**, including **6 formed through successful mergers**. This outcome underscores the community’s strong spirit of collaboration and its collective effort to design impactful, high-quality shared tasks.

Organization and Participation of the Shared Tasks

The 11 shared tasks at ArabicNLP 2025 are organized into three thematic tracks, each addressing critical needs and emerging priorities in Arabic language technology. **Together, they represent the community’s most comprehensive shared task effort to date, covering speech, multimodal processing, text quality, and cultural and ethical evaluation in the era of large language models (LLMs).**

Track 1: Speech and Multimodal Processing This track features four shared tasks that advance Arabic language processing beyond traditional text:

- **ImageEval (Arabic Image Captioning)** — 8 papers
- **Iqra’Eval (Qur’anic Pronunciation Assessment)** — 5 papers
- **NADI 2025 (Multidialectal Arabic Speech Processing)** — 7 papers
- **MAHED 2025 (Multimodal Detection of Hope and Hate Emotions in Arabic Content)** — 23 papers

These tasks address the pressing need for technologies that can process Arabic across different modalities and dialectal variations.

Track 2: Text Quality and Generation Assessment This track comprises four shared tasks focused on evaluating and enhancing Arabic text quality:

- **AraGenEval (Arabic Authorship Style Transfer and AI-Generated Text Detection)** — 16 papers
- **TAQEEM 2025 (Arabic Quality Evaluation of Essays in Multi-dimensions)** — 4 papers
- **BAREC 2025 (Arabic Readability Assessment)** — 17 papers
- **AraHealthQA 2025 (Comprehensive Arabic Health Question Answering)** — 15 papers

These tasks tackle essential challenges in automated assessment, generation evaluation, and domain-specific question answering.

Track 3: Cultural and Ethical Evaluation of LLMs for Arabic This track introduces three groundbreaking shared tasks designed to evaluate large language models’ understanding of Arabic culture and Islamic knowledge:

- **IslamicEval (Capturing LLMs’ Hallucination in Islamic Content)** — 7 papers
- **PalmX 2025 (Benchmarking LLMs on Arabic and Islamic Culture)** — 9 papers
- **QIAS 2025 (Islamic Inheritance Reasoning and Knowledge Assessment)** — 16 papers

These tasks represent a critical step toward ensuring that AI systems appropriately and accurately represent the cultural and religious contexts of Arabic-speaking communities.

Community Impact and Participation

The remarkable response to this year’s shared tasks — with **127 system submissions across the 11 tasks** — demonstrates the Arabic NLP community’s continued growth and dynamism. Participating teams represent a diverse range of institutions across multiple continents, including universities, research centers, and industry partners, reflecting both the global interest in Arabic NLP and the real-world relevance of these challenges.

The breadth of methodological approaches presented in these proceedings is particularly noteworthy, spanning traditional machine learning techniques, state-of-the-art transformer models, retrieval-augmented generation systems, and multimodal architectures. This methodological diversity not only reflects the field’s technical maturity but also highlights researchers’ creativity in addressing the unique challenges posed by Arabic language processing.

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Acknowledgments

We extend our sincere gratitude to the dedicated organizers of each shared task. Their expertise in task design, dataset development, evaluation framework creation, and ongoing participant support has been fundamental to the success of these shared tasks. The quality and impact of this volume are a direct reflection of their commitment and hard work.

We thank all participating teams whose innovative research pushes the boundaries of Arabic NLP. Their contributions address not only technical challenges but also important societal needs in education, healthcare, cultural preservation, content moderation, and ethical AI development.

We also acknowledge the program committee members, reviewers, and the ArabicNLP 2025 organizing committee for their invaluable support throughout the shared task cycle.

Finally, we gratefully acknowledge our platinum and gold sponsors whose support has made this conference and these proceedings possible.

We hope this volume serves as both a comprehensive record of the current state of Arabic NLP research and a foundation for future innovations that will continue to advance language technologies for Arabic-speaking communities worldwide.

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Sakhar Alkhereyf, Humain, Saudi Arabia.

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Website of the shared Tasks: <https://arabicnlp2025.sigarab.org/shared-tasks>

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<i>PuDyDG at AISA-ArabFC: Decomposed Fine-Tuning with Function-Centric Few-Shot Augmentation for Arabic Function Calling</i>	
Duy Dang Phu and Thìn Đặng Văn	1574
<i>QMUL_AK at AISA-ArabFC: Schema-Constrained Function Calling with ALLaM</i>	
Ali Khairallah and Arkaitz Zubiaga	1580
<i>Abjad at AISA-ArabFC: Error Analysis and Prompt Engineering for Arabic Function Calling</i>	
Randa Lakab, Shahad Abdulaziz Abdullah Alsultan and Abrar Almutiri	1585
<i>Siraj at AISA-ArabFC: Selective Argument Repair and the Limits of Post-Editing in Arabic Function Calling</i>	
Abdullah G. Alanazi and Reem K. Alshammari	1592
<i>ArgTime at AISA-ArabFC: A Modular Pipeline for Arabic Function Calling</i>	
Sabah Abdulgader Baothman	1597
<i>Optimal at AISA-ArabFC: A Hybrid Approach to Arabic Function Calling with PEFT Large Language Models and Deterministic Post-Processing</i>	
Sarah Alowjan, Lujain Al mana and Haya Buayyan Alwizrah	1603
<i>Yalla at AISA-ArabFC: Argument-Focused Fine-Tuning and Per-Argument Ensembling for Arabic Function Calling</i>	
Manish Joshi	1608
<i>aqr at AISA-ArabFC: What Actually Influences Arabic Function Calling?</i>	
Toka Khaled Abdelfattah, Eman Elrefai and Ahmed Soliman	1614
<i>Thakaa at AISA-ArabFC: Convention-Aligned Prompting and the Limits of Argument Exact Match in Arabic Function Calling</i>	
Hassan Alqaeri, Meshal Alamr and Abdullah Aldahlawi	1621
<i>Makeen at AISA-ArabFC: Grounding LLM via Extracted Spans and Generalization Trade-off in Arabic Function Calling</i>	
Nouf Alzahrany, Abir Korched and Bassam Mattar	1635
<i>Arabic Function Forge at AISA-ArabFC: Copy, Don't Interpret — Training-Free Arabic Function Calling</i>	
Anfal Alshehri and Jumanah Aljubayri	1654

Program

Friday, November 8, 2024

08:45 - 08:30	<i>Welcome & SIGARAB Update</i>
09:30 - 08:45	<i>Beyond Resources: Building an Arabic NLP Ecosystem Rooted in Representation, Collaboration, and Responsibility, by Dr. Houda Bouamor</i>
09:15 - 10:30	<i>LLM Benchmarking & Development (1)</i>
10:30 - 11:00	<i>Coffee Break</i>
11:00 - 12:30	<i>LLM Benchmarking & Development (2)</i>
12:30 - 14:00	<i>Lunch Break</i>
14:00 - 14:30	<i>Multimodality</i>
14:30 - 15:30	<i>Shared Tasks (1)</i>

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Friday, November 8, 2024 (continued)

16:00 - 15:30 *Coffee Break*

14:30 - 15:30 *Shared Tasks (2)*

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17:00 - 18:00 *Poster presentations + Shared Task posters*

Saturday, November 9, 2024

08:45 - 08:30	<i>Welcome</i>
09:30 - 08:45	<i>From Benchmarks to the Real-World Impact: Arabic LLMs in Production, by Dr. Areeb Alowisheq</i>
09:30 - 10:30	<i>Round Table (1)</i>
10:30 - 11:00	<i>Coffee Break</i>
11:00 - 12:30	<i>Education and Speech</i>
12:30 - 14:00	<i>Lunch Break</i>
14:00 - 14:30	<i>Legal & Agents</i>
14:30 - 15:30	<i>Arab Culture & Retrieval</i>
16:00 - 15:30	<i>Coffee Break</i>
16:00 - 17:00	<i>Discussion Roundtable (2)</i>